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AI Engineer

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SE3 Labs
Forward Deployed Team
Munich

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Application for Forward Deployed Engineer, Applied AI

Dear SE3 Labs team,

I am writing to apply for the Forward Deployed Engineer, Applied AI position at SE3 Labs. I have a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and three years of experience building and deploying AI applications, much of it working directly with the people who use them.

Kniit is an early-stage startup, and since November 2025 its LLM-powered knowledge-extraction system for the German energy sector has been mine to build: I am the only developer and answer directly to the CTO. I own it from ingestion and prompt design to the multi-agent LangGraph system and the deployed tools around it. I built three indexing strategies (agentic, deterministic and monolithic) and scored each against an SAP-derived reference set, which took precision from 33% to 93% and recall from 45% to 90%. Where an LLM was not the right tool, I wrote a deterministic pipeline instead and cut a projected $200,000 LLM budget to near-zero recurring cost.

The customer side of the role is the part I learned at Covestro. As an AI consulting intern I worked with business stakeholders to understand how they made decisions, advised where agentic AI could help, and then built the solution myself: a LangGraph application with a FastAPI backend and a React front end, containerized with Docker and deployed to AWS with CDK. At Kniit I work with SAP domain experts the same way, and gave them a review app on Azure where they validate and approve each extracted change.

Two gaps I should name. My German is at B1 level: I can follow and hold everyday conversations and I am improving it, but I would not yet run a customer workshop in German. I also have no defence background. I would be glad to join field tests and exercises and learn how your customers work on site.

Your operators steer several autonomous systems by voice, often where GPS cannot be trusted, and this role is the one that puts that research in front of them and makes it hold up on the day. Building something, watching people use it in the field and showing a better version the next day is how I like to work.

I am based in Munich, am happy to travel regularly within Germany, hold an EU Blue Card and can start on 15 November 2026. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

Chandu Prasad Bhairapu